



Ryan Skeels

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(cv & portfolio)

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 Denver, Colorado

Onboarding & Enablement

- Onboarding program design & delivery
- Training material & SOP development
- Cross-cultural communication
- Change management & tool adoption
- Customer success & relationship management
- Multilingual instruction & support
- Process design & improvement
- Cross-functional collaboration

Tools

- Slack (administered)
- Google Workspace (Sheets, Docs, Drive, Calendar)
- QuickBooks
- Adobe Illustrator & Photoshop
- Canva

AI in Practice

- Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini
- Documentation & summarization
- Research & workflow acceleration

Technical

- Web Accessibility Testing (DHS Trusted Tester / WCAG)
- HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Node.js, SQL
- Alt-text, ARIA, semantic HTML, screen reader testing

Language

- English (Native)
- Spanish (B1 - B2)

Operations and training leader with 15+ years of experience helping people succeed with complex systems — writing the materials, delivering the information, and building the operational infrastructure that makes it all scale. Known for adapting to the audience, communicating across language and cultural barriers, and staying present while people figure it out. Experienced in cross-functional coordination, process design, tool implementation, and change management. Actively developing skills in web development and accessibility.

Training & Enablement Highlights

Regulatory Onboarding — Denver's food industry

Worked across Denver's diverse restaurant and food service community, onboarding operators from all over the world onto complex public health regulatory requirements. Developed compliance materials in plain language — procedural guides, temperature logs, kitchen signage — tailored to operators with varying levels of English proficiency, building genuine understanding.

System Rollout & Staff Training — Baere Brewing

Led evaluation, rollout, and staff training for two successive POS systems, a new time-tracking platform and evolving production procedures. Built training documentation and standard operating procedures, delivered hands-on sessions, troubleshooted in real time, and managed resistance to change — driving successful adoption across a 10-person team.

Technical Equipment Training — Jeffco Open Space

Developed training materials and delivered hands-on training for seasonal field crews on chainsaw operation, heavy machinery, and equipment maintenance — adapting instruction to varying experience levels and ensuring safety compliance across multiple concurrent projects.

Accessibility-Focused Educational Materials — Special Olympics

Designed and developed educational materials for Special Olympics International, including accessible icon libraries, visual public health timelines, and slide decks helping individuals with developmental disabilities and their allies navigate healthcare systems — applying user-centered design throughout.

Experience

Co-Owner | Co-Founder | Operations Manager

Baere Brewing Company | Denver, CO | 2012 - 2023

- Conceived, built, ran, and eventually sold a respected production and hospitality business over the course of twelve years — designing the systems, training the team, and building the documentation that made it run independently.
- Wrote all training documentation and SOPs across every role in the business — front of house, back of house, and production — enabling independent execution and consistent onboarding of new staff
- Led implementation of two successive POS systems and a new time-tracking platform — building training, delivering sessions, troubleshooting in real time, and driving adoption across the team
- Administered Slack as the team's primary communication platform from 2016, managing channels, workflows, and information flow across staff and operations
- Spearheaded COVID-19 operational pivot: launched online ordering and new fulfillment workflows, trained staff on new processes in real time, and coordinated across vendors and evolving regulatory requirements
- Built and maintained operational tracking systems (Google Sheets, QuickBooks) for production scheduling, financials, and inventory — improving visibility and decision-making
- Oversaw ~\$500K annual budget including payroll, accounting, tax compliance, and financial reporting

English Language Teacher & Tutor

CEIP San Clemente & Online | Sedaví, Valencia, Spain | October 2024 - Present

- Deliver bilingual instruction across multiple classrooms and age groups, adapting materials, pacing, and approach to meet students where they are
- Develop lesson plans, educational materials, and assessment tools tailored to varying proficiency levels and learning needs
- Use AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT) to streamline content generation, lesson planning, and workflow efficiency

Content Designer & Visual Communications Specialist

Andrea Moore Arts | Special Olympics International projects | June 2024 - Present

- Created a cohesive icon library aligned with disability-related vocabulary and curated a visual public health timeline aligned with accessibility standards
- Designed presentation materials and educational slide decks focused on navigating healthcare systems for individuals with developmental disabilities and their allies, including alt-text for images to support screen reader compatibility

Business Sale & Relocation to Spain

March 2023 - Present

- Managed sale and operational handover of Baere Brewing Company; relocated family to Valencia, Spain for a planned period of language immersion and cross-cultural experience

Environmental Health Investigator II

City of Denver Public Health & Environment | Denver, CO | 2012 - 2014

- Worked across Denver's diverse business community, communicating regulatory requirements and developing compliance materials — procedural guides, temperature logs, kitchen signage — for operators with varying levels of English proficiency
- Authored training video scripts and developed training programs for new staff and facility operators on regulatory standards and safe operating practices
- Managed a self-directed inspection program, tracking compliance deadlines, follow-ups, and enforcement actions across a large facility portfolio with no administrative support

Natural Resource Specialist

Jefferson County Open Space | Golden, CO | 2008 - 2012

- Developed training materials and delivered hands-on training for seasonal crews on chainsaw operation, heavy machinery, and equipment maintenance
- Supervised and coordinated field crews of 6–8 across multiple concurrent projects, balancing work site requirements, team needs, and individual strengths
- Planned, designed, executed, and reported on large-scale forest restoration and habitat conservation projects across public lands

Education

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

B.A. Science - Forest Management | 2006

International TEFL Academy, Chicago, IL - Online

Teaching English as a Foreign Language Certification | 2023

Taronja Spanish Language School, Valencia, Spain

Continued Learning | 2023 - 2024

La Pagoda Spanish Language School, Valencia, Spain

Continued Learning | 2024 - 2025

Technology

Trusted Tester, Online

DHS Web Accessibility Testing Certification | June 2025

Full Stack JavaScript Course, Online

Self-led Web Development Curriculum | 2025 - Present